

CraftRoots

Where travelers become makers, and artisans become hosts.

CraftRoots serves two audiences simultaneously. On one side: domestic and international travelers across India who want meaningful cultural immersion — people planning weekend getaways, heritage routes, or cultural detours who are tired of passive sightseeing and can't find authentic, hands-on local experiences on any mainstream travel platform. On the other: India's 64 lakh artisans spread across every state and craft tradition — the block printers of Jaipur, the blue pottery makers of Jodhpur, the Warli painters of Maharashtra, the cane weavers of Assam, the Madhubani artists of Bihar, the lacquerware craftspeople of Channapatna — all of them highly skilled, most of them entirely dependent on middlemen, and none of them with a direct channel to the travelers who pass through their towns every single weekend.

Across India, the same story repeats itself in hundreds of craft towns. A traveler arrives, glances at a workshop, buys a finished product at a bargained-down price, and leaves — never knowing they could have sat down and made something themselves. Artisans stand meters away from customers who would pay 5–10× more for an hour of hands-on learning than for a finished product on a shelf, but there is no platform to connect them, no trust layer to make booking feel safe, and no structured format to make the experience repeatable. Udaipur's blue pottery studios, Kutch's embroidery clusters, Varanasi's weaving lanes — every one of them sits on an untapped experience economy that travelers actively want but cannot access. The problem is not lack of demand and not lack of skill. It is a complete absence of infrastructure that turns the craft into an experience. Travelers can't find it; artisans can't offer it; and so the encounter that should happen, in town after town across the country, never does.

CraftRoots creates the missing infrastructure between curious travelers and skilled artisans at scale — across every major craft tradition and travel destination in India — by turning traditional workshops into bookable, immersive learning sessions. Travelers discover verified artisan experiences in the cities and towns they're already visiting, book a session in minutes, arrive at a real working workshop, make something with their own hands under the artisan's guidance, and leave with a souvenir they built, not bought. Artisans earn 2–3× more per session than from product sales, gain direct access to high-value customers for the first time, and are recognised as cultural hosts rather than commodity suppliers. India has the craft density, the travel demand, and the cultural appetite — CraftRoots is the single platform that finally connects them.

The experience discovery engine lets travelers browse verified craft experiences by location, craft type, duration, group size, and price — whether they're planning a trip to Rajasthan, a weekend out of Bangalore, or a cultural day in Varanasi. Verified artisan profiles give each host a credible, searchable presence with craft background, session photos, participant reviews, and a trust score, so travelers book with confidence rather than hope. The seamless booking and payment system handles date selection, group sizing, and secure in-app payment, with automatic pre-session guidance sent to the traveler on confirmation. The hands-on session format structures each 2–4 hour workshop so every participant makes their own piece under the artisan's instruction — no passive observation, no spectating, no shortcuts. Every participant leaves with the piece they made, a self-made souvenir that carries a story no shelf product can replicate or bargain down. The artisan income dashboard lets hosts across the country manage availability, track bookings, and view earnings in real time — replacing unpredictable wholesale income with stable, session-based revenue. As the platform scales, a craft map of India emerges: a living, bookable atlas of the country's living heritage.

Before CraftRoots, a traveler visiting Jaipur walks through a block-printing studio, watches for two minutes, buys a printed scarf for ₹200, and moves on. With CraftRoots, they book a 3-hour block-printing session the night before, carve their own block, print their own fabric, and leave with something they made — at a price point they were happy to pay and a memory they'll talk about for months. Before CraftRoots, a Kutch embroidery artisan sells her work through three layers of middlemen, never meets the customer who wears it, and earns a fraction of what the finished piece sells for in a Delhi boutique. With CraftRoots, she hosts small groups of travelers directly, teaches her craft, earns 2–3× per session compared to product sales, and builds a reputation that compounds with every review. The transformation is the same whether the craft is Madhubani painting in Bihar, pottery in Khurja, or coir weaving in Kerala — the platform is the infrastructure; the craft and the artisan are the experience.

For the traveler who has done every fort, every food tour, and every rooftop restaurant India's travel industry has packaged and re-packaged — and for the artisan who has spent a lifetime mastering a craft that tourists photograph but don't understand — CraftRoots is not another booking platform. It is a redistribution of value at national scale: from middlemen to makers, from passive consumption to active participation, from forgettable weekends to the kind of afternoon you describe to everyone you meet for the next month. India's craft traditions have survived for centuries. CraftRoots gives them an economic reason to survive the next one. The souvenir you made yourself is the only one you never leave behind.